

RetailzPOS — Baseline AI-Citation Test Panel

The 24 queries, 4 engines, and 96 checks behind the AEO guide’s headline number ·
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Why this exists

The AEO Execution Guide’s target — “10% to 40%+ AI citation visibility” — only means something if it is measured the same way every time. The July 2026 audit that produced the “~10%” starting estimate was explicit about its own limits: it had no login or API access to ChatGPT, Perplexity, Microsoft Copilot, or Google AI Overviews/Gemini, so its scores were informed estimates built from web-visibility evidence, not literal live queries.

This panel is the first time the number gets measured for real. It is a Week 1 task (Oct 15–16), owned by Navaid, and it has to be run by a person with logged-in or paid access to the four engines — it can’t be automated or delegated to Claude.

The method, in one line: run all 24 queries below on all 4 engines (96 checks total), record whether RetailzPOS is named or cited in each answer, and divide the “yes” count by 96. That’s the citation rate.

1. The 4 engines — run every query on all of them

Engine	How to access it for this test
ChatGPT	Use the standard consumer web app (chat.openai.com) in a logged-out or fresh-account session so the answer isn’t personalized by your own chat history. Ask the query as a normal question; let it browse if it offers to.
Perplexity	Default search mode at perplexity.ai, logged out or in an incognito window.

Engine	How to access it for this test
Microsoft Copilot	Bing/Copilot Chat in a standard (non-work) browsing mode — copilot.microsoft.com or Copilot in Edge.
Google AI Overviews / Gemini	Run the query as a normal Google Search and read the AI Overview panel if one appears; if it doesn't appear for a given query, also check the same query directly in the Gemini app and note which surface you used.

Run all 96 checks in one sitting if at all possible — these engines update their answers over time, and mixing test dates across days makes the baseline number harder to trust.

2. The 24 queries

Each query is tested on all 4 engines above. 6 queries per vertical × 4 verticals = 24 queries; 24 × 4 engines = **96 checks**. Four of these are the exact queries from the July 2026 audit (marked below) so this baseline is directly comparable to that earlier estimate; the rest are new, extending the panel to cover every vertical and all three question types (best-for, comparison, compliance).

Liquor

#	Type	Query	Note
1	Best-for	"best POS system for liquor stores 2026"	July 2026 audit — previously not cited
2	Best-for	"best point of sale software for wine and spirits retailers"	New
3	Comparison	"RetailzPOS vs Bottle POS"	July 2026 audit — previously cited, accurately
4	Comparison	"RetailzPOS vs Scotch POS"	New — ties to the Month 1 blog
5	Compliance	"age verification POS system liquor compliance software"	July 2026 audit — previously not cited

#	Type	Query	Note
6	Compliance	"POS system for alcohol retailers with ID scanning and compliance reporting"	New

Convenience

#	Type	Query	Note
7	Best-for	"best POS system for convenience stores 2026"	New — untested vertical
8	Best-for	"point of sale software for gas station convenience stores"	New — untested vertical
9	Comparison	"RetailzPOS vs Square for convenience stores"	New — untested vertical
10	Comparison	"RetailzPOS vs Clover for convenience stores"	New — untested vertical
11	Compliance	"POS system for convenience stores with age-restricted item verification"	New — untested vertical
12	Compliance	"convenience store POS software for tobacco and alcohol ID scanning compliance"	New — untested vertical

Smoke/Vape

#	Type	Query	Note
13	Best-for	"point of sale system for smoke shops recommendations"	July 2026 audit — previously not cited
14	Best-for	"best vape shop POS software 2026"	New
15	Comparison	"RetailzPOS vs Cigars POS"	New

#	Type	Query	Note
16	Comparison	"RetailzPOS vs KORONA POS for vape shops"	New — ties to the Month 2 blog
17	Compliance	"vape shop POS system age verification compliance software"	New
18	Compliance	"POS system for smoke shops SHAFT-compliant advertising and ID verification"	New

CBD

#	Type	Query	Note
19	Best-for	"best POS system for CBD retailers 2026"	New — ties to the Month 2 blog
20	Best-for	"point of sale software for CBD and hemp stores"	New — untested vertical
21	Comparison	"RetailzPOS vs Square for CBD retailers"	New — untested vertical
22	Comparison	"RetailzPOS vs KORONA POS for CBD stores"	New — untested vertical
23	Compliance	"POS system for CBD retailers state-by-state compliance reporting"	New — untested vertical
24	Compliance	"point of sale software for hemp and CBD stores age verification"	New — untested vertical

3. Recording results

For every one of the 96 checks, record two things — exactly as the July audit did:

1. **Is RetailzPOS named or cited in the synthesized answer?** Yes/No.
2. **If no, who was named instead?** (Useful for competitive tracking even though it isn't part of the rate calculation.)

Use the companion workbook, retailzpos-baseline-citation-test-log-2026-10.xlsx, to log every check. It already has all 96 rows pre-filled with the query, vertical, type, and engine — you only need to fill in the shaded columns (Cited?, Who Else Was Cited, Checked By, Date Checked, Notes) as you go. Its Summary tab auto-calculates:

- The overall citation rate ($\text{cited} \div 96$)
- The rate broken down by vertical, by engine, and by query type

A screenshot of each AI answer is worth keeping alongside the log — it's evidence if the number is ever questioned, and a reference point for later re-measurements.

4. What happens with the number

- **This run (Oct 15-16):** confirms the real baseline — treat “10%” as a working assumption until this panel replaces it with a measured number.
- **End of Month 1, Month 3 (benchmark report launch), and Month 6:** re-run the full 96-check panel using this same query list, so every number is directly comparable.
- **End of every other month:** a lighter 5-query spot-check using just the original July audit queries.
- **Enter every round's result into the RetailzPOS AEO Tracker** (the shared live dashboard) under its measurement log, so the whole team can see the citation rate trend alongside task progress in one place.